

OF THE 35 STUDENTS WHO HAVE DIED BY SUICIDE ACROSS IITs SINCE 2018, 12 WERE FROM IIT MADRAS, THE HIGHEST AMONG ALL IITs



↘ Oct. 10, 2022: Gudla Mahesh Sai Raj, a fifth-semester B.Tech. student of Computer Science from Andhra Pradesh, hangs himself in his hostel room

↘ Sept. 17, 2022: Surya Narayan Premkishore, a student from Kerala pursuing B.Des., is found dead in his hostel room

IIT KHARAGPUR



↘ Oct. 14, 2022: The partially decomposed body of Faizan Ahmed, a third-year student of Mechanical Engineering from Assam's Tinsukia district, is discovered in his hostel room. Police have now slapped charges of criminal intimidation and causing the disappearance of evidence on five students and two employees

IIT KANPUR



↘ Sept. 8, 2022: Prashant Singh, a Ph.D. student of Mechanical Engineering from Varanasi, is found hanging inside his hostel room

IIT HYDERABAD

↘ Aug. 31, 2022: Rahul Bingumalla, a 2nd-year MTech student from Kurnool in Andhra Pradesh, ends life by hanging in his hostel room

IIT DELHI

↘ Apr. 13, 2018: Gopal Maloo, a first-year M.Sc. student in Chemistry, hangs himself to death in his hostel room. He was a native of Hooghly district in West Bengal

Campus placements are another time when the morale of students who don't get placed in the McKinseys and the Accentures takes a beating. "The placement and internship sessions cause maximum gaps," says Baruah. "Those who don't get good placements become aloof."

According to data from the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), student suicides saw a rise of 4.5 per cent in 2021. Experts attribute this spike to the Covid pandemic and related anxieties. Many students who joined college during the pandemic attended online classes for the first two years and reached the campus only in their third year. The high academic pressure and sudden need to adjust to a new environment played havoc on many of them.

Faizan Ahmed was one such student. Hailing from Assam's Tinsukia, he had come to the IIT Kharagpur campus in the third year of his B.Tech. degree. His decomposed body was found in his hostel room on October 14, 2022. The IIT Kharagpur management said it was a case of suicide, though his family alleged he had been murdered by fellow students since he had complained to the authorities about ragging. A police probe later led to the arrest of four students, and the Calcutta High Court accused the IIT Kharagpur authorities of "trying to cover up" Ahmed's death.

CASTE DISCRIMINATION

Few are willing to acknowledge its existence but several students from the backward communities say it is something they are routinely subjected to. Many upper caste students look upon their classmates from Scheduled Castes/Tribes backgrounds as undeserving because they get admission even after scoring relatively lower marks in the joint entrance examinations (JEE). This attitude, though not always overtly expressed, is often subtly felt by the students from reserved categories. "If there is a complaint that students from reserved categories are suffering more, we can't overlook the matter," says Professor Aditya Mittal,